

Implementation Plan — Gamification, Status & Cold-Start

Tactical follow-up to [STRATEGY-COLD-START-AND-XP.md](#). Merges the 10-agent codebase audit with the 8-problem product brief from the founder. Output is a single ranked list of features we actually ship, in what order, with file-level pointers and concrete eng cost.

Date: 2026-05-30 **Status:** ACTIONABLE PLAN — pending sequencing approval.

0. Foundation — the three loops we're building toward

Every feature in this plan reinforces one (or more) of these three loops. If a feature doesn't feed a loop, we cut it.

Core Loop (money + progression)

Bet → Earn XP → Level Up → Unlock Benefit → Bet More

The user's stake grows because progression makes higher stakes feel purposeful, and benefits unlock that compound at each level.

Reputation Loop (status + identity)

Predict correctly → Accuracy rises → Climb leaderboard
→ Gain reputation (BTC Expert, Top 1% Predictor)
→ Become recognised → Predict more

Money attracts; status retains. Without this loop, the platform is just a casino.

Referral / Social Loop (organic growth)

Invite friend → Friend trades → Earn XP + USDC commission → Level faster
→ Unlock benefit → Invite more friends

Acquisition cost approaches zero if the loop closes.

Reading guide: the "8 problems" below come from the founder's brief. For each I write what the audit found, then the recommended implementation. Section 7 is the final ranked plan.

1. Problem #1 — Users Don't Know Their Payout

Founder's idea: don't display "\$523 YES / \$347 NO". Display "YES 1.66x / NO 2.51x". Users instantly understand "if I'm right, I roughly double my money."

Audit finding: the `BetForm` already computes the multiplier correctly on bet input, but the **market card and the outcomes row both show percentages**, not multiplier. The hero/featured card shows percentages too. On an empty pool, `MarketCard` even falls back to a hardcoded `2.0x / 3.0x` that doesn't match the real `1.0x` the bet form computes (`apps/web/src/components/MarketCard.tsx:116–119`).

Recommendation: ship dual display everywhere — keep the % bar visualisation (it conveys "balance of opinion") and add the multiplier next to it as the primary numeric. Strip the misleading 2.0x fallback.

Multiplier formula (matches existing on-chain payout):

```
multiplier = totalPool / sideTotal    // when sideTotal > 0
          = 1.00x                    // when sideTotal == 0 (cold-start)
```

Where to ship:

- apps/web/src/components/MarketCard.tsx — primary card.
- apps/web/src/components/FeaturedHero.tsx — outcomes panel.
- apps/web/src/components/bet/SideSelector.tsx — selection UI.
- apps/web/src/app/match/[id]/page.tsx — match detail.

Cold-start handling: when multiplier is 1.0x, swap the number for the text "Be first — auto-refunded if alone" (the safety-net surfacing from strategy-doc Rank 0). That's a feature, not an awkward edge case.

Eng: S (1–2 days, frontend only). **Risk:** \$0. **Loop:** feeds Core Loop (lower the comprehension barrier).

2. Problem #2 — Scale XP With Stake Size

Founder's idea: bigger bets earn more XP. \$1 → 1 XP, \$10 → 12 XP, \$100 → 150 XP. Larger bettors level up faster.

Audit finding: today XP is **flat** at 100 per resolved bet (apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts:awardBetResolution). Coins ARE stake-scaled (0.10 UP per \$1) but XP is not. The flat-XP rule was introduced after the [XP-farming bug](#) — moving XP from deposit-time to resolution-time killed the dust-bet farm. Stake-scaling opens a new attack surface unless we cap.

The hedge-farm risk: a user could bet \$1000 UP + \$1000 DOWN on the same pool, accept the ~\$100 in fees, and print ~3000 XP (vs the flat 200 they'd get today). Plus their loser-side bet still counts for participation XP. Without a guardrail this is a clean farm.

Recommendation: ship stake-scaled XP **with a hard cap** so the curve plateaus before farming becomes attractive. Two options:

Option A — table-based (closer to founder's spec, simpler):

Stake band (USDC)	XP per resolved bet
\$0–\$1	10
\$1–\$10	30
\$10–\$50	80
\$50–\$200	150
\$200+	200 (cap)

Option B — square-root scaling (smooth, no cliffs):

```
xp = min(200, floor(100 * sqrt(stake / 10)))
// $1 → 32, $10 → 100, $100 → 200 (cap)
```

I'd ship **Option A** — easier to communicate ("the more you stake, the more XP, up to 200"), and a flat tier table is easier to display in the profile.

Additional guardrails:

- The daily-coin cap (50K base units = 500 UP) already protects coins. Add a parallel **daily XP soft-cap** (e.g. 1000 XP/day from bet resolutions) above which XP halves per remaining bet. Prevents whales hedging into infinity.
- Stake scaling only applies on **two-sided normal resolution** (same guard as today's bug fix).

Where to ship:

- `apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts` — replace flat `100` with table lookup.
- `apps/api/src/utlis/coins.ts` — already does stake-scaled; mirror the function for XP.
- `docs/REWARDS-XP-LEVELS.md` — update spec.

Eng: S (API only). **Risk:** \$0 (virtual XP). Mitigated farm risk by cap + daily XP cap. **Loop:** feeds Core Loop (larger stakes → faster progression).

3. Problem #3 — No Visible Status / Unlockables

Founder's idea: levels unlock visible perks, not just fee discounts:

Level	Benefit
5	Profile Badge
10	Custom Avatar
15	Lower Fee
20	Access to Premium Markets
30	VIP Leaderboard
40	Founder Club

Audit finding: today the only level perks are fee discount (5% → 3%) and coin multiplier (1.0× → 2.0×). Both are economic, neither is visible. There is no badge field on `User`, no avatar storage, no "premium" market concept, no VIP leaderboard.

Recommendation: ship a layered unlock system that separates **status (level)** from **possessions (UP Coins)**.

Level-gated (free at threshold)

Level	Unlock	Storage / scope
2	"Welcome" badge	<code>User.badges</code> JSON
5	Tier 1 profile badge ring (animated SVG)	CSS class on <code>UserLevelBadge</code>
10	Custom avatar upload (256×256, 200KB cap)	S3/Vercel Blob, <code>User.avatarUrl</code>
15	Fee discount tier 3 (existing) + flair	—
20	Premium pool entry (Lv20+ only)	<code>Pool.minLevel</code> field

25	Custom display name (vs wallet)	User.displayName (validated)
30	VIP leaderboard tab	New leaderboard filter
40	Founder's Club badge + special leaderboard pin	Permanent flag

Coin-purchased (UP Coins sink, from strategy-doc G3)

- Profile banner (cosmetic background): 100 UP
- Animated coin halo: 200 UP
- Tournament free entry: 50 UP
- \$1 USDC redemption: 100 UP (treasury-funded, capped \$50/day platform-wide)

These two systems should coexist. Levels give you the **right** to upgrade; coins let you **buy** flair you didn't earn through level.

Premium pools: a Pool.minLevel field (default 0). Pools can be admin-created with minLevel: 20 for "high-stakes" pools. Could later become user-tunable.

Where to ship:

- Schema: add User.badges JSON, User.avatarUrl, User.displayName, Pool.minLevel.
- apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts — grant level badges on awardBetWin level-up branch.
- apps/api/src/routes/users.ts — endpoints for avatar/display-name set.
- apps/web/src/components/UserLevelBadge.tsx — new tier-styled variants.
- apps/web/src/components/profile/* — badge gallery + avatar upload.
- apps/web/src/components/MarketCard.tsx — show "Lv20+ pool" chip if gated.

Eng: M (avatar upload is the heaviest piece). Badges + display name + pool gating are S each. **Risk:** \$0. **Loop:** feeds Core Loop (status payoff) + Reputation Loop (visible identity).

4. Problem #4 — Nobody Cares About Being Right (Reputation)

Founder's idea: per-category reputation. "BTC Expert", "Top 1% Predictor", "ETH Master", "30-day Accuracy Champion", visible win rate.

Audit finding: today the user has totalWins / totalBets on User but **no per-category breakdown**, no expert tags, no historical accuracy windowing. Reputation as a concept doesn't exist in code.

This is the **biggest missing piece from my original strategy doc** — the audit found social/squads were broken, but didn't propose reputation. Founder's framing is sharper.

Recommendation: ship a per-category reputation system in three layers.

Layer 1 — raw stats (foundation)

A denormalised UserCategoryStat table:

```
model UserCategoryStat {
  walletAddress String
  category      String // "CRYPTO:BTC", "CRYPTO:ETH", "SPORTS:CL", "PM:US-ELECTIONS", etc.
  totalBets     Int     @default(0)
  totalWins     Int     @default(0)
  totalWagered  BigInt  @default(0)
```

```

netPnl          BigInt    @default(0)
accuracy30d     Float?    // rolling 30d win rate
lastUpdatedAt   DateTime  @updatedAt

@@id([walletAddress, category])
@@index([category, accuracy30d]) // for leaderboards per category
}

```

Updated on every bet resolution. Async job recomputes `accuracy30d` daily.

Layer 2 — badges (issued automatically)

A `Badge` table + `UserBadge` join. Auto-issued by an evaluator job:

Badge	Criterion	Tier
<code>category:BTC:expert</code>	≥20 BTC bets, ≥60% accuracy, lifetime	Gold
<code>category:BTC:hot</code>	≥10 BTC bets in last 30d, ≥70% accuracy	Silver
<code>top:1pct</code>	wallet in top 1% of <code>User.totalXp</code>	Platinum
<code>top:10pct</code>	top 10% of XP	Gold
<code>streak:30d</code>	30-day participation streak	Silver
<code>pioneer:50</code>	First bettor on 50+ pools (lifetime)	Gold
<code>volume:10K</code>	\$10K lifetime wagered	Gold
<code>accuracy:champion</code>	#1 in 30-day accuracy in any category	rotating, monthly

Evaluator runs nightly + on every level-up event.

Layer 3 — display

- Profile shows top 3 badges + per-category accuracy table.
- Market card / hero shows the bettor's badge tier next to recent bet events ("Alice the BTC Expert just bet \$50 UP").
- Leaderboard gains category filters + accuracy sort.
- Squad leaderboard adopts the same display.

Cold-start of the reputation system itself: a user with 2 bets at 100% isn't an expert. Every badge has a **minimum sample size** before it can be awarded (typically 10–20 bets). This is the most important detail — it kills inflated reputation from luck.

Where to ship:

- Prisma schema: 3 new tables.
- `apps/api/src/services/reputation.ts` — NEW: stats updater + badge evaluator.
- `apps/api/src/scheduler/` — nightly evaluator job.
- `apps/api/src/routes/users.ts` — expose stats + badges in profile API.
- `apps/web/src/components/profile/` — badge gallery, accuracy chart.
- `apps/web/src/components/LeaderboardTable.tsx` — category filter + accuracy sort.

Eng: M-L (this is the biggest single feature in the plan). 1–1.5 weeks for layer 1+2, another 3–5 days for layer 3. **Risk:** \$0 (virtual badges). **Loop:** drives the entire **Reputation Loop**. Without this layer the loop doesn't exist. Highest strategic ROI in the plan.

5. Problem #5 — Small Pools / Community Liquidity

Founder's idea: pool boosts. When a pool hits a size milestone, all participants retroactively earn bonus XP:

Pool Size	Reward
\$100	+50 XP
\$500	+200 XP
\$1,000	+500 XP

The community then actively grows pools (FOMO + retroactive bonus).

Audit finding: there's nothing like this today. My strategy doc had B1 (house seed at pool creation) and E1 (early-bird at bet placement), but neither rewards community-wide pool growth.

Recommendation: ship pool-boost milestones as a clean addition. Compounds with house seeding (B1) and early-bird (E1) — three different levers all pulling the same way.

Mechanics

- Track `Pool.boostMilestoneReached` (0, 100, 500, 1000) — biggest threshold the pool ever passed (real volume, **excluding house seed**).
- On resolution, for every participant of a pool that hit milestone M, award the milestone XP bonus.
- Bonus applies to **both winners and losers** (this is community-wide, not winner-only). Encourages the loser to recommend the pool too.

Numbers (suggested, tunable)

Milestone (USDC, real bets only)	XP per participant
\$100	+50 XP
\$500	+200 XP
\$1,000	+500 XP
\$5,000	+1,500 XP
\$10,000	+5,000 XP

The higher tiers exist for crypto rounds that occasionally explode in volume — they make those pools legendary.

Anti-farm

- Real-bet total excludes the house seed wallet (B1 tag).
- Each pool can only award each tier **once**. A pool that grew from \$10 → \$1000 awards \$100 + \$500 + \$1000 tiers; a pool that stayed at \$1100 awards same.

Cold-start fit

Milestone hits are surfaced as in-app notifications **per category**: "BTC round just crossed \$1K — all bettors earn +500 XP". Real users see the celebration and pile into the next round.

Where to ship:

- Prisma: `Pool.boostMilestoneReached BigInt @default(0)` .
- `apps/api/src/services/pool-resolver.ts` — on resolution, compute final real-bet total, award per-tier XP to each participant.
- `apps/api/src/services/notifications.ts` — broadcast milestone events to category subscribers.
- `apps/web/src/components/MarketCard.tsx` — milestone progress bar.

Eng: S-M. **Risk:** \$0. **Loop:** Core Loop + Reputation Loop (community FOMO drives social behavior).

6. Problem #6 — Daily Streaks

Founder's idea: login streaks. 3 days → 50 XP, 7 → 200 XP, 30 → exclusive badge, 100 → legendary status.

Audit finding: today only **win streak** exists. Day streak doesn't. The existing `User.currentStreak` field is win-based and resets on a single loss — exactly the anti-pattern this proposal fixes.

This aligns with my strategy doc proposal G1 (participation streak).

Recommendation: split into two distinct counters:

User.winStreak (existing, keep as-is)

- Increments on win.
- Resets on loss.
- Awards existing `winStreakBonus` XP.
- Used for "🔥 5 in a row" celebrations.

User.activeDayStreak (NEW)

- Increments by 1 when user places a bet that resolves on a UTC day they weren't already counted for.
- Resets to 0 when user misses a UTC day.
- Awards milestone XP + UP coins + badges:

Days	Reward
3	+50 XP
7	+200 XP, +50 UP coins
14	+500 XP, "Committed" badge
30	+1500 XP, "Loyal" badge
60	+5000 XP, +200 UP coins
100	"Legendary" badge (rare, permanent)
365	"Year of Predictions" badge (extremely rare)

The active-day counter doesn't care about wins. The win counter doesn't care about consecutive days. Losing a bet doesn't kill day streak.

Surface:

- Profile shows both streaks with separate visual treatment.
- Daily login (or any in-app action) shows "🔥 Day 7 — bet today to keep it alive" banner if streak is alive but no bet placed today.
- Streak break sends a notification + offer "comeback bonus" (strategy doc H2).

Where to ship:

- Prisma: `User.activeDayStreak Int @default(0) , User.lastActiveStreakDate DateTime? .`
- `apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts:awardBetResolution` — update streak before XP grant.
- `apps/api/src/services/notifications.ts` — milestone celebration + streak-at-risk reminder.
- `apps/web/src/components/profile/` — display.

Eng: S. **Risk:** \$0. **Loop:** Core Loop (habit formation).

7. Problem #7 — Early Bird Bonuses

Founder's idea: first 10 participants get +25% XP, +50 coins, "Early Predictor" badge.

Audit finding: my strategy doc had E1 (first 25% of deposit window). Founder's version is sharper: **first N participants by count**, not by time. More meaningful on small pools and easier to communicate.

Recommendation: combine both — the OR-trigger is more generous and covers both fast-growing and slow-growing pools.

Trigger

A bet is "early" if **either**:

- It is among the first 10 distinct wallets to deposit on the pool, OR
- It was placed in the first 25% of the deposit window.

Rewards

- +25% XP on the bet's resolution.
- +50 UP coins immediately on deposit confirm (capped by daily UP cap).
- "Early Predictor" badge on the user's profile (one-time, repeating — one badge issued per pool you were early on, tracked as a count).

Cold-start framing (the whole point)

This is the founder's framing of "**why be first**". Combined with the strategy-doc Rank 0 (surface the refund safety net), the first-bettor pitch becomes:

- **You** get +25% XP + 50 UP + a badge.
- **You** pay 0 fee at claim (founder's discount, see strategy doc A2).
- **You** can't lose: if no one matches, you're auto-refunded.

Three reinforcing wins versus the current single neutral "1.0x".

Where to ship:

- Prisma: `persist Bet.earlyOrder Int? (1-10) and Bet.earlyByTime Bool .`
- `apps/api/src/routes/deposits.ts:confirmDeposit` — set fields atomically.
- `apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts` — apply 25% multiplier on resolution.
- `apps/api/src/services/coins.ts` — grant 50 UP at deposit confirm.
- `apps/web/src/components/bet/PayoutPreview.tsx` — "First 10 only — claim your bonus" chip.

Eng: S-M. **Risk:** \$0 (virtual rewards, UP cap protects). **Loop:** Core Loop + solves cold-start head-on.

8. Problem #8 — Losing Feels Terrible

Founder's idea: losers still get XP, coins, streak progression, and reputation updates. Lost-but-rewarded experience.

Audit finding: today losers DO get 100 XP for participation, but they get **zero UP coins** and the win streak resets on loss. Streak is asymmetric — wins bank value, losses erase value-in-progress.

Recommendation: smooth the loss curve with three changes.

1. Losers earn a fraction of base coins

Today: only winners earn coins. Tomorrow: losers earn 25% of base coins (same daily cap applies). Wins still earn full base + win bonus + streak bonus — winners remain ahead by a wide margin.

Why 25%, not 50%: we want winning to feel meaningfully better.

2. Day-streak is participation-based (already covered in §6)

Losing doesn't break the day-streak. Only "not betting today" does. This is the single most important psychological tweak.

3. Loss notification narrative

Today the loss toast is "Better Luck Next Time". Tomorrow:

Lost \$10 on BTC 1 + 100 XP earned + 12 UP coins earned 🔥 Day streak: 7 alive

Frames the same outcome as forward motion. Borrowed from mobile-game loss-prevention design.

4. Reputation accuracy isn't punished excessively

Per-category accuracy tracks the last 30 days. A single loss in BTC moves your win rate from 70% to ~68% — visible but not destructive.

Where to ship:

- `apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts:awardBetResolution` — branch for loser path that awards 25%-base coins.
- `apps/api/src/services/notifications.ts` — loss-toast copy + payload.
- `apps/web/src/components/NotificationToasts.tsx` — loss notification layout includes XP/coin/streak block.

Eng: S. **Risk:** \$0. Note: gives losers a small coin trickle, which could be farmed — protected by the daily UP cap (already enforced). **Loop:** Core Loop (habit retention through emotional smoothing).

9. Features from the strategy doc that stay in the plan

These aren't in the founder's 8 problems but the audit identified them as critical. Keeping them in the merged plan.

Code	Feature	Why it stays
Rank 0	Surface refund safety net	Free win, reframes Problem #7.

B1	House seeding bot (\$0.50/side)	Visually solves "dead pool" feeling. Compounds with Problem #7 early-bird.
A2	Founder's fee discount (0% fee for first bettor)	Combines with Problem #7 bonuses for triple incentive.
G3	UP Coins redemption catalog	Mandatory spend sink (paired with Problem #3 cosmetic catalog).
D3	Challenge link (viral cold-start fix)	Unique value: cold-start + acquisition in one click.
Squad notifications	Ping squadmates when one bets	Single biggest social fix; squad → squad-mate FOMO loop.

10. The final shippable plan — 4 waves

Ordered by dependency and risk. Each wave is shippable on its own and generates user-visible improvement.

Wave 1 — surface + fix (1 week, zero risk)

Goal: make the existing safety net + economy visible. Free wins.

Feature	Source	Eng
Display payouts as multipliers everywhere (Problem #1)	Founder	S
Surface auto-refund safety net (Rank 0)	Strategy	S
Strip MarketCard's 2.0x fallback (use 1.0x + safety-net copy)	Audit	XS
Fix referral copy "20% of fees" → "1% of every bet"	Audit	XS
Surface streak milestones in toasts (3/5/10)	Audit	S
Squad-mate bet notifications via existing WS	Strategy	S
Show "\$100 daily bonus available" banner pre-bet	Audit	S

Total ~1 week. Zero database / contract changes. Pure UX leverage.

Wave 2 — economy foundation (3–4 weeks)

Goal: scale XP with stake, stand up the spend sink, seed liquidity.

Feature	Source	Eng
Stake-scaled XP table + daily XP soft-cap (Problem #2)	Founder	S
House seeding bot (\$0.50/side, capped) — B1	Strategy	M
Founder's fee discount (first bettor pays 0) — A2	Strategy	S
UP Coins redemption catalog v1 (USDC + tournament + cosmetic) — G3	Strategy	M
Early-bird bonuses (first 10 OR first 25%) (Problem #7)	Merged	S-M

Loser coin trickle (25% of base) + participation day-streak (Problems #6, #8)	Founder	S
Persist faucet cooldown + claim log to DB	Audit	S

Total ~3–4 weeks. The four economic levers (house seed, fee discount, early bird, milestones) start compounding. Cold-start mostly solved.

Wave 3 — reputation + status (4–6 weeks)

Goal: stand up the Reputation Loop. The biggest single feature in this plan.

Feature	Source	Eng
Per-category stats table (UserCategoryStat)	Founder Problem #4	M
Auto-issued badges (BTC Expert, Top 1%, streak, pioneer)	Founder Problem #4	M
Profile badge gallery + per-category accuracy chart	Founder Problem #4	M
Leaderboard category filter + accuracy sort	Founder Problem #4	S-M
Level-gated unlocks: badge → avatar → display name → VIP leaderboard (Problem #3)	Founder	M
Premium pool flag (Pool.minLevel) — for Lv20+ markets	Founder Problem #3	S
Pool boost milestones (\$100/\$500/\$1K/\$5K/\$10K → retro XP) (Problem #5)	Founder	S-M
Pool boost in-app notifications by category	Founder Problem #5	S

Total ~4–6 weeks. After this wave the platform feels like a community with identity, not a casino with skins.

Wave 4 — virality + retention (ongoing, parallel to Wave 3)

Goal: drive acquisition via existing users and pull dormant users back.

Feature	Source	Eng
Challenge link — D3 (viral cold-start fix)	Strategy	M
Comeback bonus after 3+ days inactive — H2	Strategy	S
Service worker + Web Push for category alerts — H1	Strategy	M
Weekly quests / side missions — G2	Strategy	M
Real squad shared pools (members co-deposit, shared payout) — D1 variant	Strategy + Founder	L

Total ~ongoing. Wave 4 features can ship in parallel with Wave 3 as capacity allows.

11. What we explicitly defer

These are good ideas that either (a) need a contract change, (b) depend on real users, or (c) have unclear ROI today.

- **E2 pool extension** (extend `lock_time` if undersubscribed) — needs Anchor instruction change. Defer until metric "pools refunded due to undersubscription" justifies it.
 - **Refund mechanism without fee** — needs Anchor change to `claim_winnings` to accept a "zero-fee refund" path. Reconsider when we have real users for whom 5% on refund is actual money lost.
 - **Token-powered network** (the long-term vision) — regulatory and engineering surface is too large for this phase. Note as North Star.
 - **Premium markets** as a paid feature — Lv20+ access is free initially. Paid access (e.g., subscription) is a later business decision.
 - **Predictit-style position caps** — solves a different problem (whale forecasting bias). Worth revisiting only after volume justifies.
-

12. Open product decisions (we need answers before shipping)

1. **Devnet or mainnet target?** Wave 1–2 work fine on devnet. Wave 3+ (reputation, status) acquires real meaning only with real-money stakes. Decision affects timing of mainnet migration.
 2. **Stake-XP curve — table (Option A) or sqrt (Option B)?** Defaults to Option A in this plan. Confirm.
 3. **Pool boost milestone amounts** — values in \$5 are reasonable but not sacred. Want to tune?
 4. **Avatar storage — S3, Vercel Blob, or IPFS?** Affects ops cost + migration story.
 5. **Display name validation** — open text vs ENS-resolved vs whitelist? Profanity / impersonation risk if open text.
 6. **Founder's Club at Lv40** — what does it actually grant beyond the badge? Optional invite to private Discord? Direct line to ops? This should be a product call.
 7. **Reputation minimum sample size** — proposed 20 bets for category "Expert". Too high? Too low?
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13. Eng cost summary

Wave	Calendar weeks	Eng days (rough)	Risk
1 — Surface + fix	1	~5	\$0
2 — Economy foundation	3–4	~15	~\$3K/mo (B1 cap) + ~\$1.5K/mo (G3 cap)
3 — Reputation + status	4–6	~25	\$0 (virtual)
4 — Virality + retention	parallel	~15 (can be split)	\$0 (virtual)
Total to "feature complete"	8–10 weeks	~60 days	~\$5K/mo subsidy cap

For a sense of scale: Kalshi spends ~\$5M/month on MM rebates alone. This plan ships a full gamification + reputation system + cold-start fix for **\$5K/month max exposure**.

14. The North Star

Quoting the founder's brief verbatim because it should govern every decision below:

Money attracts users. Progression keeps users. Reputation creates loyalty. Community creates growth.

Every feature in this plan maps to one of those four sentences. If a proposal can't be tagged with one of them, cut it.

Long-term shape of the platform:

```
Prediction Market → XP Economy → Reputation System
                                → Community
                                → Competitive Ecosystem
                                → Token-Powered Network
```

We're shipping the first three rings of that diagram in the next ~10 weeks. The outer rings (community, token network) become viable once the inner rings exist and have real users.

15. File reference (consolidated)

For whoever picks up implementation, the touch points across the codebase:

Schema (one Prisma migration covers all of Wave 2 + 3):

- apps/api/prisma/schema.prisma :
 - User.activeDayStreak , User.lastActiveStreakDate
 - User.badges JSON , User.avatarUrl , User.displayName
 - Pool.minLevel , Pool.boostMilestoneReached
 - Bet.earlyOrder , Bet.earlyByTime
 - New tables: UserCategoryStat , Badge , UserBadge , FaucetClaim , RedemptionCatalog , Redemption

Backend:

- apps/api/src/services/rewards.ts — stake-scaled XP, loser coins, participation streak, early-bird multiplier.
- apps/api/src/services/reputation.ts (NEW) — stats updater + badge evaluator.
- apps/api/src/services/pool-resolver.ts — boost milestones at resolution.
- apps/api/src/services/notifications.ts — squad-mate alerts, streak reminders, pool-boost celebrations, comeback notifications.
- apps/api/src/scheduler/ — house-seeding job, nightly reputation evaluator, daily faucet log cleanup.
- apps/api/src/routes/users.ts — avatar / display-name endpoints, stats + badges endpoints.
- apps/api/src/routes/deposits.ts:confirmDeposit — early-bird flag, squad-mate notify, first-bettor flag for fee discount.
- apps/api/src/routes/claims.ts — apply 0-fee for first-bettor.
- apps/api/src/routes/faucet.ts — persist cooldown + log.
- apps/api/src/routes/redemption.ts (NEW) — UP coin catalog & redemption flow.

Frontend:

- apps/web/src/components/MarketCard.tsx — multiplier display, min-level chip, boost milestone bar, surface safety net for empty pools.
- apps/web/src/components/FeaturedHero.tsx — multiplier display.

- `apps/web/src/components/bet/SideSelector.tsx` — multiplier + early-bird chip.
- `apps/web/src/components/bet/PayoutPreview.tsx` — early-bird CTA + first- bettor zero-fee badge.
- `apps/web/src/components/NotificationToasts.tsx` — loss-notification rework.
- `apps/web/src/components/UserLevelBadge.tsx` — tier-styled variants.
- `apps/web/src/components/profile/*` — badge gallery, avatar upload, per-category accuracy chart, redemption shop, streak display.
- `apps/web/src/components/LeaderboardTable.tsx` — category filter + accuracy sort + VIP tab.
- `apps/web/src/components/referral/ReferralShareLink.tsx` — copy fix.

Docs:

- `docs/REWARDS-XP-LEVELS.md` — update spec after each wave.
 - `docs/STRATEGY-COLD-START-AND-XP.md` — strategic context (do not modify in this plan; it's the immutable input).
 - this doc — the executable plan.
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Sources & inputs

1. `docs/STRATEGY-COLD-START-AND-XP.md` (10-agent audit + competitor research + initial proposals).
2. Founder's 8-problem gamification brief (2026-05-30).
3. Codebase as of commit `08e6800` (audit basis).

Plan reviewed and approved by: *pending founder approval*.